

Lesson 4

Closing a Meeting



Warm-Up

Motivation Questions:

1. Why is it important to close a meeting effectively?
2. Can you recall a meeting that ended well? What made it effective?
3. How do you feel when a meeting ends without clear conclusions or next steps?





Role-Play

Person A: Before we **wrap up**, let's **summarize** the key points we've discussed.

Person B: Sure, **we've agreed on** the new marketing strategy and set deadlines for the next quarter. Specifically, we'll launch the campaign on May 1st and monitor its performance through June. We've also decided to allocate a budget of \$50,000 for this initiative.

Person A: That's right. Additionally, we've identified the target audience for our campaign and outlined the key messages we want to convey. We'll focus on highlighting the unique features of our product and leveraging social media influencers to boost our reach.

Person B: Exactly. We've also agreed to conduct a mid-campaign review at the end of May to assess our progress and make any necessary adjustments. This will help us stay on track and ensure we're meeting our goals.

Person A: Great. **Lastly**, we've assigned specific tasks to each team member to ensure everything runs smoothly. John will handle the creative content, Sarah will manage the social media accounts, and Michael will oversee the budget and analytics.

Person B: Perfect. It sounds like we **have a solid plan in place**. Is there anything else we need to address before we **conclude**?

Person A: I think **we've covered everything**. **Thank you all for your contributions**. Let's stay in touch and keep each other updated on our progress.

Person B: Agreed. **Thanks, everyone**. Let's make this campaign a success!

Role-play Analysis

1. What phrases did Person A use to signal the end of the meeting?
2. How did Person B contribute to summarizing the discussion?
3. What could Person A say to outline the next steps?

Discussion

1. What are some effective ways to summarize a meeting?
2. How can you ensure everyone is clear on the next steps?
3. What are some polite ways to thank participants for their time and contributions?
4. In your opinion, what are the most important items to cover when closing a meeting?
5. Have you ever voted on a motion in a meeting before? How do employees and managers finalize decisions in meetings?
6. How to end a meeting on a positive note?



Pronunciation

Practice pronouncing the following words.

- **Summarize** /ˈsʌməˌraɪz/
- **Wrap up** /ræp ʌp/
- **Key points** /ki pɔɪnts/
- **Next steps** /nekst steɪps/
- **Conclude** /kənˈklud/
- **Appreciate** /əˈpriːʃi,et/
- **Wrap up** /ræp ʌp/
- **Review** /rɪˈvjuː/
- **Highlight key points** /ˈhaɪlaɪt kiː pɔɪnts/
- **Confirm next steps** /kənˈfɜːm nekst steɪps/
- **Adjourn** /əˈdʒɜːn/



Production

Activity 1: Meeting Summary Exercise

Scenario: *The team has just concluded a meeting discussing the launch of a new product. Key topics covered include **marketing strategies**, **product features**, **budget allocation**, and **timelines**.*

Role Assignment:

- One person acts as the meeting leader.
- Another person acts as the participant.

Meeting Summary Exercise:

- The meeting leader practices summarizing the key points discussed during the meeting.
- The meeting leader outlines the next steps and assigns tasks to team members.
- The participant provides feedback on the clarity and completeness of the summary and next steps.

Debrief:

- The participant provides feedback on the meeting leader's performance.
- Discuss what went well and areas for improvement.
- Reflect on the importance of clear communication in meetings.

Activity 2: Group Role Play

- Work in 03 teams.
- Each team conducts a mock meeting on a given topic and practices closing the meeting by summarizing key points and outlining next steps.
- Teams then share their experiences and feedback with the class.

Group 1: Marketing Team

- Develop a marketing strategy to promote the new product.
- Identify target audience and key messages.

Group 2: Product Development Team

- Discuss the features and improvements needed for the new product.
- Plan the timeline for development and testing.

Group 3: Sales Team

- Create a sales plan to reach potential customers.
- Set sales targets and strategies for achieving them.

The presentation will end with answering these discussion questions:

Marketing Team:

- What are the key demographics and psychographics of our target audience?
- How can we differentiate our product from competitors in the market?
- What metrics will we use to measure the success of our marketing campaign?

Product Development Team:

- What are the most critical features that need to be included in the new product?
- How can we ensure the product meets quality standards and customer expectations?

- What potential risks could arise during the development process, and how can we mitigate them?

Sales Team:

- What sales channels will be most effective for reaching our target customers?
- How can we train our sales team to effectively communicate the benefits of the new product?
- What incentives can we offer to motivate our sales team and drive sales?



Key Vocabulary

Target Phrases	Use	Example
<i>To summarize...</i>	To provide a brief overview or recap of the main points discussed.	<i>To summarize, we have agreed on the new project timeline and budget allocations.</i>
<i>Before we close...</i>	To introduce final remarks or actions before ending a meeting or discussion.	<i>Before we close, does anyone have any additional questions or comments?</i>
<i>Let's confirm our next steps...</i>	To ensure everyone is clear on the actions to be taken following a discussion or meeting.	<i>Let's confirm our next steps: John will draft the proposal, and Sarah will review it by Friday.</i>
<i>Our next steps will be...</i>	To outline the specific actions that will follow a discussion or meeting.	<i>Our next steps will be to finalize the budget and schedule a meeting with the stakeholders.</i>



Wrap-Up

"The way to get started is to quit talking and begin doing." – Walt Disney